



Scan the
QR code for updates
and latest news on
gulfnews.com

Christmas & New Year OFFERS*



800 916
www.abccargo.com
*T&C APPLY



3543272_341

RTA opens 2
new bridges
ahead of
schedule

DUBAI
BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Managing Editor

Dubai's Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) has opened two new bridges under the Trade Centre Roundabout Development Project. The bridges, which opened ahead of the planned mid-January schedule, serve traffic from 2nd December Street towards Sheikh Rashid Road and Al Majlis Street, connecting directly to Al Mustaqbal Street.

Each bridge provides two lanes in both directions, with a combined length of 2,000 metres and a capacity of approximately 6,000 vehicles per hour, increasing throughput during peak hours.

With the opening of the new links, journey times from 2nd December Street to Al Majlis Street, Al Mustaqbal Street and Zabeel Palace Street have been reduced from 10 minutes to just two minutes. The improvement is expected to ease bottlenecks at the Trade Centre Roundabout, where average delays are projected to drop sharply as traffic is diverted onto grade-separated routes.

Mattar Al Tayer, Director General, Chairman of the Board of Executive Directors of the Roads and Transport Authority, said: "The project enhances traffic flow from Sheikh Zayed Road towards 2nd December Street, as well as traffic movement from Al Mustaqbal Street towards Sheikh Zayed Road in the southbound direction."

SEE ALSO P2

Mohamed, Macron discuss
historical, strategic relations

FRENCH PRESIDENT TOURS ZAYED NATIONAL MUSEUM GALLERIES DURING VISIT

ABU DHABI

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan yesterday welcomed Emmanuel Macron, President of France, who is on a working visit to the country.

The meeting was held at the Zayed National Museum in Abu Dhabi, where Sheikh Mohamed welcomed the French President. The two leaders exchanged New Year greetings and expressed their wishes for continued progress and prosperity for both nations and their peoples.

During the meeting, they discussed the historical and strategic relations between the UAE and France.

Strengthening ties

They also explored opportunities to further strengthen ties, particularly in the fields of economy, investment, and culture, as well as renewable energy, advanced technology, artificial intelligence, sustainability, and other areas aligned with the two countries' shared vision for development and prosperity.

The meeting was attended by Sheikh Khaled Bin Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi; Sheikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs; Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Chairman of the Presidential Court for Special Affairs; a number of minister and senior officials. The meeting was also attended by the delegation accompanying the French President,



UAE Presidential Court

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan hosted a luncheon in honour of Emmanuel Macron, President of France, at the Zayed National Museum yesterday.

dent, which included a number of ministers and senior officials.

Luncheon, museum tour

Sheikh Mohamed also hosted a luncheon in honour of Macron and the accompanying delegation.

Macron arrived in the UAE earlier yesterday, where he was received at the Presidential Flight in Abu Dhabi by Sheikh Khaled, along with several senior officials.

Later, the French President,

accompanied by Sheikh Khaled, toured the museum's galleries, including the section dedicated to the UAE's Founding Father, the late Sheikh Zayed Bin Sultan Al Nahyan.

This gallery highlights Sheikh Zayed's enduring human values and visionary legacy, reflecting his commitment to coexistence, modern nation-building, and the fostering of cooperation and cultural dialogue among nations and peoples worldwide.

Zayed National Museum

showcases a collection of more than 3,000 artefacts, with 1,500 currently on public display.

The visitor journey through the museum's six permanent galleries begins with the Our Beginning gallery, which is dedicated to the life and leadership of Sheikh Zayed.

His story is brought to life through recordings of his voice, archival photographs and film footage, as well as personal belongings, letters, and correspondence.

— WAM

NATION

UAE aid ship
ready to deliver
7,249 tonnes of
packed food to
Gaza | P4

PROPERTY

Why Indian
property
developers are
expanding into
the UAE | P5

IN FOCUS

Liwa
International
Festival blends
thrill with
tradition | P8-9



Subscribe in print and online

www.store.gulfnews.com
www.gulfnews.com/subscriptions
Tel : 600 587 234
E mail : circ@gulfnews.com

PRICE UAE: Dh 5.00 Bahrain: BD 0.500 Oman: RO 0.500 S.Arabia: SR 5.00 India: Rs 40.00 Pakistan: Rs 100.00

Santas & Nutcrackers

Coloring Sets

Gifting & Christmas Crackers

Ceramic Dinnerware, Wooden Trays & Tumblers

Stockings, Hats, Outfits Headbands & Glasses

Trees (2ft to 12ft)

Glasses

Banners

Horns & Stars Confetti

Eye masks & Headbands

Hats

Party Poppers, Pom-Poms & Hair Color Sprays

Glowing Bracelets & Light Sticks

2026 MERRY CHRISTMAS & HAPPY NEW YEAR

HAPPY NEW YEAR

WE ARE NOW ONLINE

www.daisojapanme.com

Abu Dhabi • Ajman • Al Ain • Dubai • Fujairah • Ras Al Khaimah • Sharjah

3545408_31